



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Pronunciation Spot: Talking about dating habits!



Learning Outcome

Describe emotions and feelings in present and past situations in spoken or written texts and in work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Is it important to date people close to your age? Why?
- Have you ever dated anyone older than you? Was the relationship successful? Why/why not?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about beliefs, opinions, relationships or character traits.
- I can emphasize different things in a statement using intonation.
- I can contrast two things by using proper intonation.





Let's Explore!

My little girl is very **inquisitive***. She is always asking questions.

* To be "*inquisitive*" means to be curious.

Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Vanessa: Hey, Bill. What brings you here so late?

Bill: I was out with some friends having some very boring conversation with them, so I thought I'd come here and have some interesting conversation with you instead.

Vanessa: I don't know if I have anything terribly thought-provoking to tell you Bill. Why was your discussion with your friends so especially dull?

Bill: My friends like to talk about all their possessions, whereas I prefer talking about experiences. Listening to them was utterly un compelling.

Vanessa: No one wanted to talk about your trip to the Maldives?

Bill: Nah! Although conversation did pick up especially when we started talking about you.

Vanessa: Me? Why were you talking about me?

Bill: My friends were inquisitive. They wanted to know more about you. They would ask me questions like: Is she married or single? Who does she like better shy guys or outgoing guys? Does she like tall guys or short guys? Does she prefer Coke or Pepsi?

Vanessa: Haha. I'm a Pepsi girl.

Bill: Well, I was completely embarrassed because I couldn't answer any of their questions; and I wish I could. You see, I like you Vanessa, and I would like to get to know you better.

Vanessa: Bill, are you asking me out on a date?

Bill: Even better, I'm asking you to come to the Maldives with me.

Vanessa: You must be joking!

Bill: Why? How long have we known each other?

Vanessa: We've known each other for about a year.

Bill: Do we get along well?

Vanessa: Yes.

Bill: Do we like one another?

Vanessa: Yes.

Bill: So? What's the trouble?

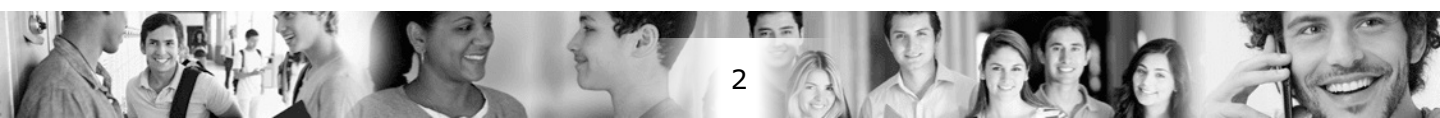
Vanessa: It is extremely short notice for one thing. The other is I manage your Bistro. Who would run the place if I'm gone? I almost fired someone tonight. This is not the best time to go traipsing around the world.

Bill: It's the perfect time! The staff will be just fine. You don't have to stay away for an extended absence. Just for a nice little getaway. You deserve a break and I'll take care of everything.

Vanessa: But Bill, we are just friends.

Bill: Friends go on vacation together, don't they? Sun and sand or a frigid Boston winter? I'm leaving at the end of the week so you have sometime to think it over. Besides, didn't you once tell me you loved to be spontaneous? Goodnight!

Vanessa: Goodnight, Bill.



**Let's Practice!**

Bill and Vanessa talk about their night.

Instructions: Proofread the sentences. Correct the mistake. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1) I was out with friends having some very bored conversation.

2) Listening to them was utterly uncompelled.

3) Why was your discussion with your friends so especially dulled?

4) I was completely embarrassing.

5) It is extreme short notice.

**Let's Practice!**

Vanessa and Bill try to organize their feelings!

Instructions: Organize the mystery sentences. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

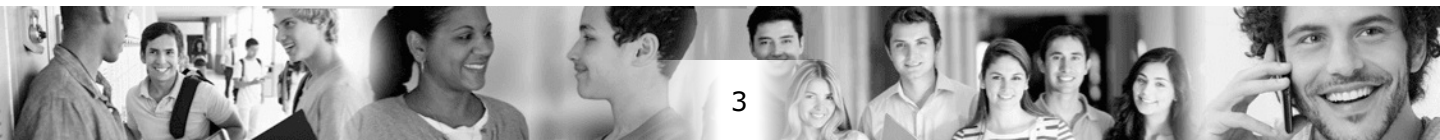
1) anything / I / terribly / have / thought-provoking / don't / know / if / . / I

2) utterly / to / un compelling / Listening / was / . / them

3) is / not / This / around / time / . / world / best / traipsing / to / the / the / go

4) a / Just / little / for / . / nice / getaway

5) Sun / ? / or / a / winter / and / sand / frigid / Boston





Extension Activity

Setting your partner up on a date!

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- You have a friend who you'd like to set up with your partner.
- Your partner is unsure and makes a list of ten contrastive questions to ask. (eg. Is she tall or is she short? Does he like rock music or reggae music?)
- You must persuade your partner emphasizing your friend's qualities. (eg. She is extremely tall or he is very smart.)
- After the ten questions, your partner must decide if they were persuaded or not.
- Switch roles.

Self-Assessment

Yes **No**

I create a role play with my partner.

☐ ☐

I use Contrastive Stress questions to learn more information.

☐ ☐

I use Emphatic Stress to answer my partner's questions.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **thought-provoking** (adjective): stimulating careful consideration or attention
e.g. I don't know if I have anything terribly thought-provoking.
- **uncompelling** (adjective): not interesting
e.g. Listening to them was utterly uncompelling.
- **to traipse** (verb): to walk wearily or with reluctance
e.g. This is not the best time to go traipsing around the world.
- **extended absence** (noun): a long period of time spent away from one's responsibilities
e.g. You don't have to stay away for an extended absence.
- **getaway** (noun): a vacation
e.g. Just for a nice little getaway.
- **frigid** (adjective): very cold in temperature
e.g. Sun and sand or a frigid Boston winter?





Learning Points

Emphatic Stress

When you want to call attention to something special that you want to emphasize in a sentence, you can change the stress from the main noun of the sentence, to another content word (adjective or adverb).

To emphasize a word, you can change the stress from the principal word to another content word. By choosing a word other than the one you normally stress, you put emphasis on the new one.

For example:

That was a difficult **exam**. - *Standard statement*

That was a **difficult** exam. - *Emphasizes how difficult the exam was*

The following adverbs or intensifiers are commonly used emphatically: extremely, terribly, completely, utterly, especially

Read these sentences aloud. Focus on the emphatic stress.

Examples:

- *I was out with friends having some **VEry** boring conversation.*
- *I don't know if I have anything **TERRibly** thought-provoking to tell you.*
- *Listening to them was **UTTerly** uncompelling.*
- *Why was your discussion with your friends so **eSPECIAlly** dull?*
- *I was **COMPLETely** embarrassed.*
- *It is **EXTREMely** short notice.*





Learning Points

Contrastive Stress

There are various types of stress patterns used when speaking English.

When you want to point out the difference between one object and another, you use contrastive stress.

You tend to use contrastive stress with determiners such as *this*, *that*, *these* and *those*.

For example:

*Do you like **this** one or **that** one?*
*I like **this** one.*

When you use contrastive stress, as with any other stress pattern, you need to raise the pitch and volume of your voice when you pronounce the stressed word.

Practice saying these sentences from the dialogue:

Examples:

- *I was out with friends having some very boring conversation with them, so I thought I'd come here and have some interesting conversation with you instead.*
- *My friends like to talk about all their possessions, whereas I prefer talking about experiences.*
- *Is she married or single?*
- *Who does she like better, shy guys or outgoing guys?*
- *Does she like tall guys or short guys?*
- *Does she prefer Coke or Pepsi?*

